



Customer account management.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — SALES

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines how the Sales team assigns new and dormant customer accounts to account managers, how account ownership is tracked, and how monthly outreach to open accounts is coordinated. The goal is to make rotation transparent, prevent two reps from working the same account at the same time, and keep DSS Distro's outreach consistent from the customer's point of view.

2. Scope

Applies to every active account manager on the Sales team and to every customer account flagged as Open in ACT the CRM. Out of scope: customers already assigned to an account manager and currently in a live sales cycle — those remain with the assigned rep and are not re-rotated under this SOP.

3. Definitions

TERM	DEFINITION
Open account	A customer account with no sales in the last twelve months. Open accounts have no assigned account manager and are part of the rotation pool.
Act	Our Customer Relation Management system (CRM)
Contact attempted	A documented outbound phone call where the rep could not reach the customer (no answer, voicemail, hung up, or spoke only to a staff member).
Contact reached	A documented outbound phone call where the rep spoke directly with the decision-maker at the account.

Mass email	A monthly marketing email sent to all Open accounts. A mass email does NOT count as a contact attempt for rotation purposes.
Customer activation spreadsheet	The shared sheet that records whose turn is next, all prior account assignments, and the contact history that drives rotation decisions.

4. Roles and responsibilities

- **Account managers** — log every call attempt and reach in the CRM, respect another rep's in-progress account, and take their turn when a new customer or unowned Open account lands.
- **Customer Success** — owns the customer activation tracker, assigns the next rep when a new customer or unowned Open account is received, and resolves rotation disputes.
- **Marketing / Sales support** — schedules the monthly email blast to Open accounts and inserts the rotating sender name for each cycle.

5. Customer activation spreadsheet

The customer activation spreadsheet is the single source of truth for rotation. It is visible to every account manager so each rep can see whose turn is next and review the history of past assignments.

The spreadsheet has two tabs:

1. **Tab 1 — SOP reference.** A copy of this SOP (or a link to it) so every rep can confirm the rules without leaving the sheet.
2. **Tab 2 — Whose turn is next.** The rotation log. Each row records the customer assigned, the rep who received the assignment, the date, and the trigger (new customer, Open / Act pickup, or mass-email reply).

Reps are expected to backtrack against their prior rows to make sure every assigned request has been closed out before taking on the next one. New customer requests in particular should be prioritised — they are warmer leads and are easier to convert.

6. New customer and unowned-account assignment

Account managers alternate. When a request lands, the Sales Manager consults Tab 2 of the customer activation spreadsheet and assigns the request to the rep whose turn is next. The following rules decide which queue a request enters.

New customer requests:

- Assigned to the next rep in rotation, with no preconditions.
- Recorded immediately in Tab 2 so the rotation pointer advances.

Open or Act accounts coming back to DSS:

1. Check the account's contact history in ACT.
2. If no rep has attempted or reached the customer by phone, treat the account as new — assign it to the next rep in rotation.

3. If a rep has already attempted or reached the customer by phone, the account stays with that rep so they can carry on the work they started. Other reps do not approach the account.
4. Mass-email activity is ignored at this step. Anything that was a mass email is considered uncalled, not called, and does not establish ownership.

7. Three-month re-opening rule

Ownership of an Open account is not permanent. If the rep who claimed the account has had no phone activity — attempt or reach — on that account for three full months, the account returns to the rotation pool and any other rep may pick it up. The three months runs from the date of the most recent logged phone activity, not from the date of the first contact.

This rule applies only to Open Act accounts in the rotation. It does not apply to a rep's assigned customers — those remain with the assigned rep regardless of call cadence.

Worked example:

- A rep logs a phone attempt on an Open account on 15 January.
- That rep does not log any further phone activity for the rest of January, February, March, or April.
- On 16 April, the three-month window has closed. Any other rep may now claim and call the account.

Mass-email sends in the intervening period do not reset the clock. Only logged phone attempts or phone reaches count.

8. Monthly email blasts to open accounts

DSS sends one mass email per month to all Open accounts. The blast is sent under the name of an individual sales rep — not a generic mailbox — and the sending rep rotates from one month to the next. The rotation is recorded in the customer activation spreadsheet.

Rotating the sender protects fairness between reps and protects DSS's image with the customer: the customer does not receive back-to-back outreach from different DSS reps in the same month, which would look uncoordinated.



Figure 1 — Example banner from a monthly email blast to Open accounts.

9. Mass-email replies and ownership

Replies to monthly blasts are routed using these rules:

- **Direct reply to the blast** — the customer is assigned to the rep whose name was on that month's blast. The reply lands in that rep's inbox; the account is theirs.
- **Indirect or out-of-band response** — if a customer reaches out independently and the response cannot be tied to a specific recent blast, the account goes to whichever rep is next in rotation, per Tab 2.

10. Contact logging discipline

Rotation only works if contact history is recorded accurately and consistently. The legacy practice of marking Shopify customer notes with informal flags — for example "Eric was here" — is retired. All phone activity is logged in ACT with hard data.

Every logged call entry records:

- The customer account.
- The rep who placed the call.
- The date of the call.
- The outcome: **Reached** (spoke with the decision-maker) or **Attempted** (no answer, voicemail, hung up, or spoke only to a staff member).

Reps working high-value accounts — referred to internally as "whales" — keep ownership by logging at minimum one phone attempt or reach per month. Once three months pass without a logged phone activity, the account returns to the pool regardless of value.

Non-Compliance

Reps who approach an Open or Act account that is still inside another rep's three-month window forfeit any commission tied to that account for the cycle, and the account stays with the original rep. Reps who fail to log phone attempts in the customer activation spreadsheet lose protection of their claim — if the activity is not in the sheet, it did not happen, and the three-month clock cannot be backdated. Persistent or repeat violations are escalated to the Sales Manager for review at the rep's next one-on-one.

Exceptions

The Sales Manager may override rotation in writing when a customer explicitly requests a specific rep, when continuity with a prior rep is required to close an in-flight deal, or when onboarding a new rep who needs leads to work. Every exception is recorded as a row in Tab 2 of the customer activation spreadsheet with the reason in the trigger column, so the rotation log remains a complete history.